

■ B.2.5 Special Input

<code>?symbol</code>	get information
<code>??symbol</code>	get more information
<code>?s₁ s₂ ...</code>	get information on several objects
<code>!command</code>	execute an external command
<code>!!file</code>	display the contents of an external file

Special input lines.

In most implementations of *Mathematica*, you can give a line of special input anywhere in your input. The only constraint is that the special input must start at the beginning of a line.

Some implementations of *Mathematica* may not allow you to execute external commands using `!command`.

<code>*</code>	any sequence of letters and digits
<code>@</code>	any sequence of lower-case letters and digits
<code>**</code>	any sequence of letters, digits and \$

Metacharacters recognized by ?.

You can ask for information from *Mathematica* without specifying the name of an object exactly. You can include special “metacharacters”, which can stand for different sequences of ordinary characters. Functions like `Names` and `StringMatchQ` allow the same metacharacters.